

and digital infrastructure.

Our approach is not to attract one-off investments but to build complete industrial ecosystems where suppliers, manufacturers, research institutions and skilled talent grow together.

As companies pursue a “China Plus One” strategy, Andhra Pradesh offers political stability, competitive infrastructure, abundant land, clean energy and a government committed to quick execution.



Manufacturing growth depends on skilled manpower. What initiatives has the state undertaken to create a future-ready workforce for advanced manufacturing and Industry 4.0?

Talent is our most important competitive advantage.

We are aligning higher education, technical institutions, and skill development with industry requirements. Our universities are increasingly partnering with global technology companies to ensure students graduate with industry-relevant skills.

102 | Recently, we launched Sri City International University, with a unique LEG (Learn, Earn, and Graduate) model. While they learn, students will undertake paid internships with companies in Sri City. We are focusing on AI, robotics, automation, semiconductor design, electronics manufacturing, advanced manufacturing technologies, and digital engineering.



Investors today seek policy stability and faster approvals. What reforms has your government introduced to make Andhra Pradesh more competitive than other states?

Investors consistently tell us they value predictability more than promises. Our government’s philosophy is built around three principles, which I call the three S’s: Simple, Speed, and Stability.

We have streamlined approval processes, strengthened single-window systems, improved coordination across departments, and ensured faster decision-making at the highest levels. More importantly, we believe governments must behave like long-term partners in the industry. That means transparent policies, responsive administration, and consistent implementation. The ease of doing business is not just about rankings; it is about building investor confidence every single day.



What are the biggest challenges you continue to

face in attracting large-scale manufacturing investments, and how do you intend to address them?

Manufacturing investments are becoming increasingly competitive globally. States today compete not only with each other but also with countries across Asia and West Asia.

Our challenge is to continuously strengthen infrastructure, logistics, industrial ecosystems, and skilled talent while maintaining competitiveness.

The answer lies in long-term planning rather than short-term incentives. We are investing ahead of demand, i.e. in ports, roads, power, digital infrastructure, industrial parks and workforce development—so investors can scale with confidence. We see every challenge as an opportunity to build stronger institutions and better infrastructure.



Looking ahead to 2030, what would you consider the biggest milestone for Andhra Pradesh’s manufacturing and technology ecosystem?

By 2030, I would like Andhra Pradesh to be recognised globally as one of Asia’s fastest-growing destinations for advanced manufacturing, digital infrastructure, and clean energy.

Success would mean globally competitive manufacturing clusters, large-scale electronics production, thriving renewable energy industries, world-class AI infrastructure, strong exports and, above all, millions of quality jobs for our youth. Ultimately, our success will not be measured by investment announcements alone, but by the opportunities created for the people of Andhra Pradesh.



If you had to convince a global CEO to invest in Andhra Pradesh over any other Indian state, what would be your strongest pitch?

I would say this: If you are looking for a government that treats your investment as a long-term partnership rather than a transaction, come to Andhra Pradesh.

As I always say, once you invest in Andhra Pradesh, it is no longer your project. It is our project. Most importantly, we move with purpose. Decisions are faster, coordination is stronger, and implementation is closely monitored. It is this speed, stability and service that sets Andhra Pradesh apart. **BT**

@tweettokarishma